STANDARD IQ · PARTNER PROPOSAL

Subscriptions & Digital Distribution

How Standard IQ turns a 3-million-user network into a paying readership, and how every edition reaches each subscriber through a personal, secure link.

October 2026 · Draft for discussion · Prices in US dollars

THE PRODUCT

A 124-page monthly that Africa's quality leaders already read

Each edition is built around deadlines and decisions: transitions, the institutions behind them, and what businesses must do next.



FROM THE PUBLISHER

Standard IQ

Quality belongs in the public conversation

Standards help determine who can compete, what people can trust and whether Africa's industrial ambitions become dependable results.

Norman Ndlovu

Chief Executive Officer
Afrolso

An entrepreneur can have a good product and a willing buyer, yet still struggle to complete an order. The nearest suitable testing laboratory may be prohibitively far away, or a consignment may face further assessment because the evidence accompanying it is not accepted at its destination. For a small business, the resulting costs and delays can put a hard-won commercial relationship at risk. Consumers depend on these same systems when they need assurance that a product is safe and will perform as promised.

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THE STANDARD IQ DOSSIER

Khaled Soufi: widening the influence of developing countries

The Egyptian standards chief has made broader participation a priority of his ISO presidency. For African institutions, influence will depend on the expertise they can sustain throughout the drafting process.

Standard IQ Editorial Desk

Khaled Soufi. Portrait supplied by Standard IQ.

Khaled Soufi took office as ISO President on 1 January 2026 with a commitment to give developing countries a stronger voice in shaping international standards. His three-year term brings the chairman of the Egyptian Organization for Standardization into a global governance role whose priorities include helping national institutions contribute more effectively to the technical decisions that affect their economies.

Soufi's professional background spans engineering, quality management and standards

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IQ BRIEF GLOBAL

Environmental transition follows its own dates

Organisations using ISO 14001 and ISO 9001 can coordinate preparation, but their transition deadlines differ.

Standard IQ Editorial Desk

Organisations managing quality and environmental certification together face two transition calendars. Under Global ACI's applicable arrangements, existing ISO 14001:2015 certification must transition by 30 April 2029—five months before the ISO 9001 deadline.

The environmental timetable, announced on 14 September 2026, requires accreditation bodies to be ready to assess ISO 14001:2026 by 31 October 2026. Accredited certification bodies must submit their transition declarations and supporting information by 31 January 2027. Accreditation decisions on those transitions are due by 30 April 2027.

From 31 October 2027, new and initial accredited environmental management system certifications may be issued only against ISO 14001:2026. These requirements cover Global ACI Multilateral Recognition Arrangement signatories and their accredited certification bodies within the relevant scope.

Shared processes can make coordinated preparation worthwhile. Internal audits, management reviews and staff training may support both transitions, provided each standard's requirements receive adequate attention.

Organisations should agree assessment arrangements with their certification body early enough to accommodate the environmental deadline. A combined management system does not make the two timetables interchangeable.

124
pages in the Oct–Nov 2026 edition

54
African markets in scope

12
editions a year, live on the 5th

THE VALUE

Subscribers pay for deadlines, access and judgement, not just articles

Deadlines they can't miss

ISO 14001:2015 certificates must move to ISO 14001:2026 by 30 April 2029. ISO 9001 and ISO/IEC 17024 transitions follow their own dates.

Practical guidance

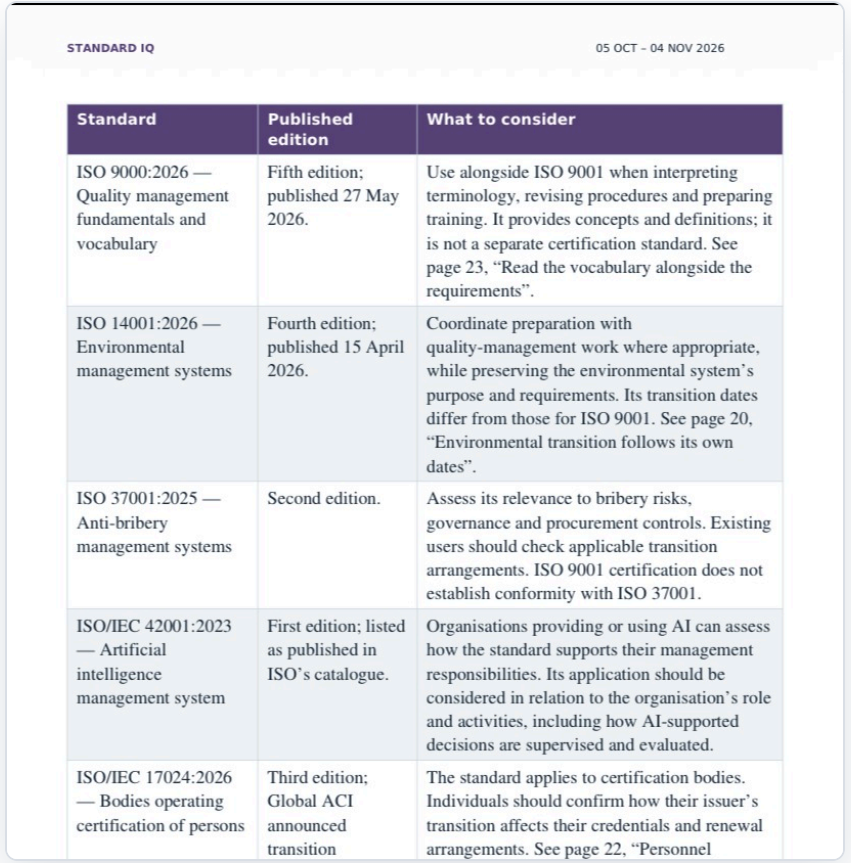
Tables like "what to consider" for each new standard turn news into action for quality managers.

Access to decision-makers

Dossiers on the ISO President, ARSO and the AU Commission. Readers can't get this view anywhere else.

Independence

"Informed. Independent. ISO Smart." Clear labels on all paid content keep that promise credible.



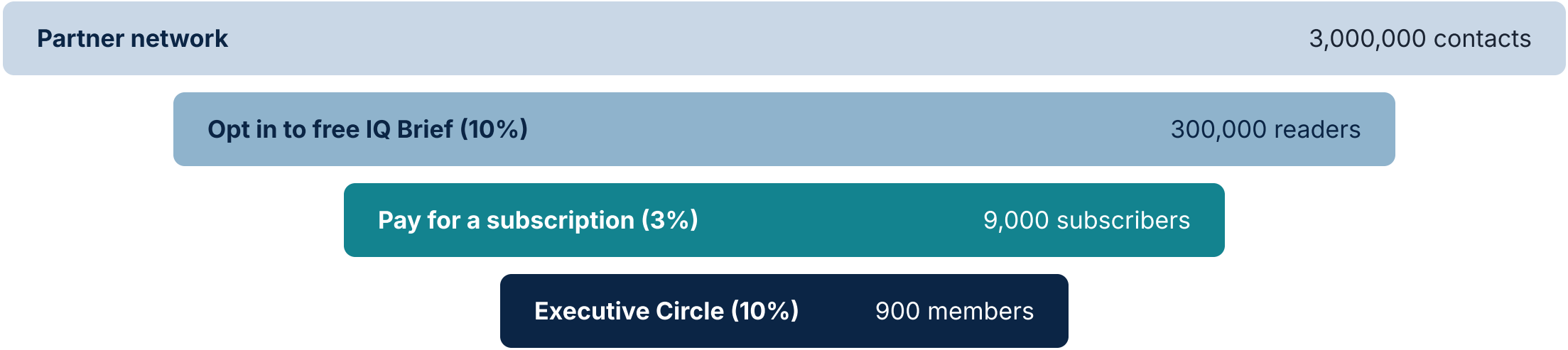
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Standard	Published edition	What to consider
ISO 9000:2026 — Quality management fundamentals and vocabulary	Fifth edition; published 27 May 2026.	Use alongside ISO 9001 when interpreting terminology, revising procedures and preparing training. It provides concepts and definitions; it is not a separate certification standard. See page 23, “Read the vocabulary alongside the requirements”.
ISO 14001:2026 — Environmental management systems	Fourth edition; published 15 April 2026.	Coordinate preparation with quality-management work where appropriate, while preserving the environmental system’s purpose and requirements. Its transition dates differ from those for ISO 9001. See page 20, “Environmental transition follows its own dates”.
ISO 37001:2025 — Anti-bribery management systems	Second edition.	Assess its relevance to bribery risks, governance and procurement controls. Existing users should check applicable transition arrangements. ISO 9001 certification does not establish conformity with ISO 37001.
ISO/IEC 42001:2023 — Artificial intelligence management system	First edition; listed as published in ISO’s catalogue.	Organisations providing or using AI can assess how the standard supports their management responsibilities. Its application should be considered in relation to the organisation’s role and activities, including how AI-supported decisions are supervised and evaluated.
ISO/IEC 17024:2026 — Bodies operating certification of persons	Third edition; Global ACI announced transition	The standard applies to certification bodies. Individuals should confirm how their issuer’s transition affects their credentials and renewal arrangements. See page 22, “Personnel

THE MODEL

From 3 million contacts to about 9,000 paying subscribers

This is the base case. Everyone gets something free; a focused group pays for the full edition and alerts.



Opt-in comes first: WhatsApp only allows messages to people who agreed to hear from Standard IQ. All rates are assumptions to be tested in the pilot.

PRICING

Four individual plans, from free to $29 a month

FREE

IQ Brief

$0

always free

- Weekly headlines on a WhatsApp Channel and by email
- 3 full articles a month
- Edition cover and contents page

For the whole partner network: this is the funnel

STARTER

Student & Early Career

$2

per month · ID verified

- Full monthly edition
- Archive access
- Deadline alerts for 2 standards

Students, trainee auditors, junior quality staff

MOST POPULAR

Professional

$6

per month · or $60 a year

- Full edition and full archive
- Weekly IQ Brief, full version
- Deadline alerts for every standard you follow
- "Ask the desk": 1 question a month

Quality managers, auditors, consultants

PREMIUM

Executive Circle

$29

per month · or $290 a year

- Everything in Professional
- Quarterly closed-door virtual roundtable
- Member directory and curated introductions
- Watermarked PDF downloads
- 20% off Standard IQ events

CEOs, heads of standards bodies, directors

WHY IT'S FAIR

$60 a year costs less than one standard document

Cheaper than the alternatives

A single ISO standard costs over 100 Swiss francs, and one day of transition training typically costs several hundred dollars. A year of Standard IQ costs $60.

Priced for local incomes

Plans are charged in local currency at local price points, not straight US dollar conversion, so a reader in Lagos and one in Johannesburg pay a similar share of income.

Low-risk to try

14-day free trial, cancel any time from WhatsApp by replying STOP, and annual plans get 2 months free.

Market	Professional / month	Per year
South Africa	R99	R990
Kenya	KES 650	KES 6,500
Nigeria	~~₦~~6,500	~~₦~~65,000
Egypt	EGP 199	EGP 1,990
Other markets	$6	$60

Indicative local prices, to be set at launch and reviewed every quarter as exchange rates move.

TEAMS & INSTITUTIONS

Organisations buy seats, which makes revenue steadier

Plan	Who	Price
Team	5–49 staff, managed by one admin	$48 / seat / year
Organisation	50+ staff, single invoice, usage report	$36 / seat / year
Institution	Standards bodies, regulators, universities: unlimited staff	from $2,400 / year

Companies pay by invoice and renew yearly. An admin dashboard adds or removes staff by email or phone number, and every seat gets the same personal-link delivery.

GETTING SUBSCRIBERS

Signing up takes under two minutes, without leaving the phone

1

Discover

Partner message, WhatsApp Channel post, LinkedIn or a QR code in the edition.

2

Opt in

Reader replies **JOIN** on WhatsApp, or taps the sign-up link. Consent is recorded.

3

Verify

One-time code to the phone; email added for receipts and backup delivery.

4

Choose plan

Pick a plan and the standards to follow (ISO 9001, 14001, 45001, 27001…).

5

Pay

Card, debit order, M-Pesa or bank transfer through Paystack, Flutterwave or Stripe.

6

Welcome

Payment confirmed automatically; the current edition's personal link arrives in seconds.

Every partner sign-up carries a referral code, so revenue share is calculated automatically.



DISTRIBUTION

How each edition reaches every subscriber on the 5th

1 · Publish

Editorial uploads the final edition to the content system and schedules release.

2 · Match

System selects every active subscriber and the articles that fit their chosen standards.

3 · Personalise

A unique, signed link is created for each subscriber and each edition.

4 · Send

WhatsApp message at 07:00 local time, with the same link by email as backup.

5 · Read & measure

Reader opens the edition in the browser. Opens and reading time feed reports.

What the subscriber sees on WhatsApp (example)

```
Good morning Thandi, the Oct–Nov edition of Standard IQ is
ready.
This month: ISO 14001 transition dates, and the ISO President
on Africa's voice.
Read now: iq.standardiq.com/r/K7M2QX
Reply LINK for a new link · STOP to unsubscribe
```

Technology, all off the shelf

- WhatsApp Business Platform through an official provider (360dialog, Twilio or Infobip)
- Subscriber database and link service (for example Supabase / Postgres)
- Payments: Paystack, Flutterwave, M-Pesa and Stripe
- Email backup: Brevo or Postmark · Secure web reader for the edition

PROTECTING PAID CONTENT

A personal link instead of a PDF, so forwarding doesn't give the edition away

ANATOMY OF A LINK (EXAMPLE ADDRESS)

`iq.standardiq.com/r/K7M2QX`

The code is unique to **one subscriber** and **one edition**. It is signed by the server, so it can't be guessed or edited, and it can be switched off instantly if the subscription ends.

Plain PDFs get forwarded into WhatsApp groups within hours, and then nobody needs to subscribe. The PDF stays a perk for the Executive Circle, watermarked.

Two devices per subscriber

A third device triggers a one-time code to the subscriber's own phone, so a forwarded link doesn't open.

Visible watermark

Each page shows the reader's name and the last digits of their number, which discourages screenshots and sharing.

Self-service

Reply LINK for a fresh link; links stay valid for the edition's month and archive access continues while subscribed.

At most six messages a month, each one useful

When	Message	Who gets it
5th, 07:00	New edition, personal link	All paid
Every Tuesday	Weekly IQ Brief	Free and paid
As needed	Deadline alert for a followed standard	Paid
3 days before renewal	Renewal reminder with pay link	Mobile-money payers
Day 12 of trial	"Your trial ends in 2 days"	Trial users

Target: monthly churn below 5%, and at least 60% of each edition's links opened within 7 days.

Failed payment

Three automatic retries over 7 days, each with a WhatsApp nudge and pay link. Access stays open during this grace period.

Paused, not deleted

After the grace period, access pauses but preferences and history are kept. Paying again restores everything at once.

Win-back

30 days after a lapse: one message with the latest headlines and a single-month offer.

UNIT ECONOMICS

About $3.80 of each $6 Professional subscription stays with the publisher

Per subscriber, per month	USD
Subscription price	**6.00**
Payment processing (about 3.5%)	−0.21
WhatsApp messages (6 × a few cents)	−0.06 to −0.18
Email, hosting and secure reader	−0.06
Partner revenue share (30%, example)	−1.80
Left for the publisher	**≈ 3.75–3.87**

WhatsApp charges by message type and country. Check Meta's current rate card for each launch market before signing.

REVENUE SCENARIOS

The base case reaches about $81,000 a month in subscriptions

Monthly figures	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Opt-in rate from 3M contacts	5%	10%	15%
Free readers	150,000	300,000	450,000
Paid conversion of free readers	2%	3%	4%
Professional subscribers ($6)	2,700	8,100	16,200
Executive Circle members ($29)	300	900	1,800
Individual revenue	$24,900	$74,700	$149,400
Teams & institutions (avg $2,400 / yr)	10 · $2,000	30 · $6,000	60 · $12,000
Total gross per month	**$26,900**	**$80,700**	**$161,400**
Total gross per year	**$0.32M**	**$0.97M**	**$1.94M**

Gross before payment fees, messaging and partner share. Advertising and sponsorship come on top (see the separate rate card).

Agree five terms, then pilot with 50,000 users

Terms to agree with the partner

- **Revenue share**, calculated on net revenue and tracked by referral code
- **Subscriber relationship** stays with Standard IQ; partner gets monthly reports
- **Messaging costs**: who pays for the opt-in campaign and ongoing sends
- **Consent and data protection** under POPIA, Nigeria's NDPA and Kenya's DPA
- **Term and exclusivity**, with minimum performance targets

Month 1 · Build

Sign-up, payments, personal-link service and web reader. Approve WhatsApp message templates.

Month 2 · Pilot

Opt-in campaign to 50,000 partner users. 14-day trials; test $5 vs $6 for Professional.

Month 3 · Launch

Roll out to the full network in weekly waves; start selling team and institution plans.

Informed. Independent. Delivered to every subscriber, personally.

Decisions needed from the partner: revenue share, who covers messaging costs, and a pilot start date.